



tmux / Byobu Quick Reference

Byobu profile (tmux backend, GNU Screen keys) · vi copy mode · 100k scrollbar

PREFIX
Ctrl + a

PREFIX 2
F12

WINDOW MANAGEMENT (Byobu F-keys)

F2	New window	F8	Rename window
F3 / F4	Previous / next window	Ctrl + Shift + F8	Re-order windows by number
Shift + F3 / F4	Move window left / right	P &	Close window
Alt + F3 / F4	Move focus to pane left / right	P 0-9	Jump to window #

PANES & SPLITS

Shift + F2	Split horizontally (stacked)	Alt + ↑↓	Move focus to pane up / down
Ctrl + F2	Split vertically (side-by-side)	P z	Zoom / unzoom pane
Ctrl + ←→↑↓	Move between panes	P q	Show pane numbers (jump)
Shift + ←→↑↓	Resize pane	P x	Kill pane

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS (Byobu)

F5	Reload profile, refresh status	Shift + F12	Toggle mouse support on/off
F6	Detach session	Alt + F12	Toggle keybindings on/off
F7	Enter copy / scrollbar mode	Ctrl + a Ctrl + a	Last active window
F9	Byobu configuration menu	P d	Detach (prefix style)

COPY MODE & SCROLLBACK (vi keys — press F7)

Space	Start selection	P]	Paste buffer
Enter	Copy selection	q or Esc	Exit copy mode
/ ?	Search down / up	PgUp / PgDn	Scroll while in copy mode

SESSIONS

<code>byobu new -s name</code>	New named session	<code>byobu kill-session -t name</code>	Kill session
<code>byobu ls</code>	List sessions	P \$	Rename session
<code>byobu attach -t name</code>	Attach to session	P ()	Prev / next session

HANDY TIPS

- ▶ Send a literal **Ctrl-a** to the shell (line start): press **Ctrl-a a** or just **F12** first.
- ▶ Your profile already sets `history-limit 100000` and `mode-keys vi` — no config needed.
- ▶ Reload config without restarting: `tmux source-file ~/.byobu/.tmux.conf` (or just hit **F5**).
- ▶ Use P **:** for the tmux command prompt — every action has a named command.
- ▶ Synchronize panes (type in all at once): `setw synchronize-panes on`.
- ▶ Pair-programming: both users attach to the same session with `byobu attach -t name`.
- ▶ **F9** → "Toggle status notifications" customizes the status bar widgets.
- ▶ Escape delay is already 0 (`escape-time 0`) — no lag when hitting Esc in vi/Helix.